Vim

Modal editing, operators, motions, search, splits, and macros

MODES AND FILES

i / I
Insert at cursor / line first nonblank.

a / A
Insert after cursor / end of line.

o / O
Open new line below / above.

Esc / Ctrl-[
Return to Normal mode.

:w / :q / :wq / :q!
Write / quit / write+quit / force quit.

:e <file>
Edit a file.

:help <topic>
Open built-in help.

u / Ctrl-r
Undo / redo.

.
Repeat the latest change.

ZZ / ZQ
Save+exit / exit without saving.

NAVIGATION

h j k l
Move left/down/up/right.

w / b / e
Word forward / back / to end.

W / B / E
WORD motions (whitespace-delimited).

0 / ^ / $
Column 0 / first nonblank / end of line.

gg / G / 42G
First line / last line / line 42.

Ctrl-f / Ctrl-b
Scroll page forward / back.

Ctrl-d / Ctrl-u
Scroll half-page down / up.

%
Jump to matching bracket.

f<char> / t<char>
Find character / move before character.

; / ,
Repeat character search / reverse.

Ctrl-o / Ctrl-i
Jump backward / forward through jump list.

OPERATORS AND TEXT OBJECTS

d / c / y + motion
Delete / change / yank motion.

dd / cc / yy
Act on current line.

dw / cw / yw
Operate on word.

diw / ciw / yiw
Operate inside word.

dap / cip / yi"
Around paragraph / inside paragraph / quotes.

d$ / c$
Delete / change through end of line.

x / X
Delete char at / before cursor.

p / P
Paste after / before cursor.

"ay / "ap
Yank / paste using register a.

"+y / "+p
System clipboard (if compiled with support).

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3dd / 5j
Counts repeat operations and motions.

VISUAL SELECTION

v / V / Ctrl-v
Character / line / block Visual mode.

> / <
Indent or outdent selection.

=
Autoindent selected lines.

gv
Reselect previous visual selection.

o
Move to other endpoint of selection.

SEARCH AND REPLACE

/pattern / ?pattern
Search forward / backward.

n / N
Next / previous match.

*** / #**
Search word under cursor forward / backward.

:noh
Clear highlighted matches.

:%s/old/new/g
Replace all file matches.

:%s/old/new/gc
Confirm each replacement.

:g/pattern/d
Delete lines matching expression.

BUFFERS AND WINDOWS

:ls / :bn / :bp
List / next / previous buffers.

:b <number> / :bd
Go to buffer / close buffer.

:split / :vsplit
Split horizontally / vertically.

Ctrl-w h/j/k/l
Change active split.

Ctrl-w = / Ctrl-w q
Equalize / close split.

:tabnew / gt / gT
New / next / previous tab.

:e!
Discard changes and reload disk file.

MACROS, MARKS, FOLDS

qa ... q / @a
Record macro a / replay macro.

@@ / 10@a
Repeat latest / run ten times.

ma / 'a / `a
Set mark; jump to mark line/column.

za / zc / zo
Toggle / close / open fold.

zR / zM
Expand / close all folds.

:make / :copen / :cnext
Build and navigate quickfix list.

KEY CONSIDERATIONS

EDITOR GRAMMAR: [count] + operator + motion/text object. Examples:

ci(changes inside parentheses; diw deletes inner word; 5j moves

down 5 lines. These are built-in Vim keys, not plugin mappings.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION

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`https://www.vim.org/docs.php`

`https://vimhelp.org/quickref.txt.html`